Untrained Qwen: What the Baseline Actually Measures

Experiment index

Question and Context

Does fine-tuning help compared with the same local model without an adapter?

This note records the bare Qwen reference. Hosted GPT and scripted results are different baselines: hosted inference changes the model, while scripted responses test the harness rather than learned behavior.

Setup

Base Qwen2.5-1.5B-Instruct, no LoRA adapter, evaluated through the local runner and fake tools.

Use the training-prompt-a314 artifact when comparing with similarly prompted historical adapters. The "historical" artifact predates some policy/scoring changes and is not interchangeable.

Results

Evaluation	Cases	Task success	Tool accuracy	Argument accuracy	Clarification wording	Refusal wording
Bare Qwen / historical settings	150	32/150 (0.213)	0.500	0.791	0.036	0.019
Bare Qwen / matched training prompt	150	32/150 (0.213)	0.493	0.791	0.025	0.034
Bare Qwen	30	7/30 (0.233)	0.483	0.947	0.000	0.000

Values are ratios from 0 to 1, rounded to three decimals. Clarification/refusal columns measure wording criteria, not routing alone. Different suite sizes remain separate evaluations.

Result Provenance

- Bare Qwen / historical settings: 2026-09-26 UTC, 150 cases.
- Bare Qwen / matched training prompt: 2026-09-26 UTC, 150 cases.
- Bare Qwen: 2026-09-27 UTC, 30 cases.

Interpretation

The historical combined suite measured 32/150 task successes. The matched-training-prompt evaluation also had 32/150, but some tool/wording metrics differed. Template-shift success was 7/30.

This establishes that "same task-success rate" can hide different behavior. It also explains why 50-, 150- and 30-case percentages should not be placed in one improvement curve.

Limits

These base results predate later strict-parser measurements. A clean claim that a modern checkpoint beats base needs a method-matched base artifact, not simply the largest improvement over any historical baseline.

Reported local API cost of zero does not include electricity, hardware or training cost.

Supporting Files

The result links above are the surviving primary evidence. A separate immutable training record was not established for this historical experiment.

Notes assembled on 2026-10-10 from saved artifacts and repository records. No training, inference or result modification was performed to write this note.

PDF exported 2026-10-12. Original Markdown and benchmark evidence are preserved. Local artifact links require the project files.